

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Are you a shrewd social media user, or do you feel like your online social circle is shrinking?



Learning Outcome

Explain about technology and technical problems in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Do you think you behave differently online compared to real life? Why or why not?
- Do you think we rely on our devices too much? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about technology.
- I can say and use the sound shr.
- I can use proper intonation in statements and questions.





Let's Explore!

Sally believes that technology will make the world a better place, but Amanda **is not buying it***. Why not?

* When you "don't buy it", you don't believe something is true.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** I just had the most amazing interview with a technology advocate. He showed me how virtual reality will take over the world. People from all over the world will be able to connect and experience the same thing at the same time. I can't wait until it gets published in the next issue!
- Amanda:** Hmm ... I don't think I'm looking forward to this scenario.
- Sally:** Why are you shrugging? You don't think that computers can help people connect with each other?
- Amanda:** I think we're becoming too dependent on electronic devices. I thought that social media would have helped me keep in touch with my contacts, but I feel like my social circle has shrunk because of it.
- Sally:** Why do you say that? Do you mean you don't enjoy the time you spend online?
- Amanda:** It seems that every time I visit a forum, everyone shouts at each other for no reason. Sometimes when I read online comments all I hear is people shrieking at me.
- Sally:** I know ... I try to stay away from that kind of website.
- Amanda:** Yeah. It makes me want to put these useless debates through a shredder.
- Sally:** Oh Amanda, you're such a luddite. Don't you think you should try to adapt instead?





Let's Practice!

Time to pronounce the *shr* sound.

Instructions: Circle the words where the shr sound appears.

1. Why are you shrugging?
2. I feel like my social circle has shrunk because of social media.
3. Sometimes when I read online comments all I hear is people shrieking at me.
4. It makes me want to put these useless debates through a shredder.



Let's Practice!

What's the big deal* about technology? Let's hear it!

*When you ask "What's the big deal", you want to know what's so important about something.

Instructions: Choose from the words below to complete the sentences.

Word Bank

- | | | |
|-----------------|--------------|--------------|
| • social media | • online | • no reason |
| • connect | • enjoy | • computers |
| • because of it | • forum | • each other |
| • same time | • every time | • contacts |
| • shouts at | • helped me | • the world |

1. People from all over _____ will be able to _____ and experience the same thing at the _____.
2. You don't think that _____ help people connect with _____?
3. I thought that _____ would have _____ keep in touch with my _____, but I feel like my social circle has shrunk _____.
4. Do you mean you don't _____ the time you spend _____?
5. It seems that _____ I visit a _____, everyone _____ each other for _____.



Extension Activity

Write a dialogue about the danger of new technologies.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- With a partner, talk about the dangers of new technologies and the problem of becoming dependent on electronic devices.
- Write a dialogue of 12 - 14 lines on this topic.
- Give information on the problem. Stress the new information.
- Ask for clarification. Stress the correct words in the questions.
- Try to disagree with your partner. Stress the important words in your statements.
- Use at least 3 words with the *shr* sound.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I use words with the *shr* sound.

☐ ☐

I stress new information.

☐ ☐

I use the proper intonation in long questions and statements.

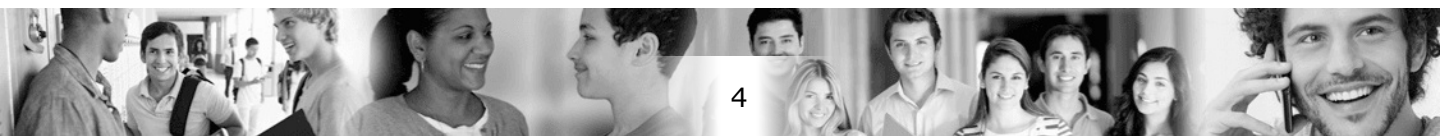
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I discuss the problems associated with new technologies.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- advocate** (noun): a person who strongly supports a cause or an idea
e.g. I just had the most amazing interview with a technology advocate.
- scenario** (noun): a possible outcome
e.g. I don't think I'm looking forward to a scenario where virtual reality takes over the world.
- to shrug** (verb): to raise one's shoulders to express doubt or indifference
e.g. Why are you shrugging? You don't think that computers can connect everyone?
- dependent** (adjective): relying on something or someone
e.g. I think we're becoming too dependent on electronic devices.
- to shrink** (verb): to get smaller; to reduce
e.g. I feel like my social circle has shrunk because of social media.
- forum** (noun): a public space
e.g. Every time I visit a forum, everyone shouts at each other for no reason.
- to shriek** (verb): to produce high-pitched, piercing sounds
e.g. When I read online comments all I hear is people shrieking at me.
- luddite** (noun): a person with a strong dislike for technology
e.g. You're such a luddite. Don't you think you should try to adapt instead?
- shredder** (noun): a machine in an office used to destroy something, usually documents
e.g. It makes me want to put these useless debates through a shredder.





Learning Points

Consonant Blends - the *shr* Sound

Consonant clusters like *shr* can occur at the beginning of a word in English. Practice blending the sound from one consonant sound into the next without adding a vowel sound in between.

Read the following words aloud.

Example:

shrink	shrank	shrunk	shrewd
shred	shredder	shriek	shrug

Examples:

• **Ann:** *I feel like my social circle has shrunk because of social media.*

Bob: *Yeah. It makes me want to put these useless debates through a shredder.*

Intonation in Long Questions

Intonation is important in statements and in long questions. You use the rise and fall of your voice to show the listener when you are or are not finished.

In long questions, the intonation falls and then rises to show the question is not finished. The intonation rises or falls at the end, depending on whether it is a yes/no question or a piece of information.

Say these sentences. Vary the intonation on the bolded words. Be sure to notice if the question is an information or yes/no question.

You don't **think** that computers help people **connect** with each **other**?

Do you **mean** you don't enjoy the **time** you spend **online**?

Don't you **think** you should **try** to adapt **instead**?

